TECHNICAL SERVICE BULLETIN
B-Pillar Ticking Sound With NEW Grab Handle Design

reissue
26-2221
10 June 2026

This reissue replaces all previous versions. Please destroy all previous versions. Only refer to the electronic version of this TSB.

This bulletin supersedes 26-2036. Reason for update: Add/Remove/Update Production Dates, Revised Service Procedure (TSB/GSB) / Text (SSM)

Model:

Ford 2023-2026 Ranger	Build Date: 23 November 2023 – 23 February 2026 Assembly Plant: AAT- RAYONG ASSEMBLY PLT-LS (AAGDZ) Double Cab
2023-2026 Ranger	Build Date: 13 January 2024 – 04 June 2025 Assembly Plant: HAIDUONG ASSEMBLY PLT(VIETNAM) (AAGBS) Double Cab
2023-2026 Ranger	Build Date: 23 November 2023 – 26 January 2026 Assembly Plant: THAILAND LTD PLANT BUILD (AAGB7) Double Cab
2023-2026 Everest	Build Date: 23 November 2023 – 23 February 2026 Assembly Plant: AAT- RAYONG ASSEMBLY PLT-LS (AAGDZ)

Summary

This bulletin supersedes TSB 26-2036. Reason for update: Update Service Procedure and Vehicle Applications.

Issue: Some 2023-2026 Ranger double cab and Everest vehicles with the new style grab handle bracket design may experience a ticking type sound at the B-pillar area.

Action: Follow the Service Procedure below on vehicles that meet all of the following criteria:

- Ticking sound from the B-Pillar
- Vehicles with the following build dates:
  - Ranger Thailand production built from 23-Nov-2023 to 26-Jan-2026
  - Ranger AAT production built from 23-Nov-2023 to 23-Feb-2026
  - Ranger Vietnam production built from 13-Jan-2024 to 04-Jun-2025
  - Everest AAT production built from 23-Nov-2023 to 23-Feb-2026

NOTE: In cases where vehicles that have a build date (after those listed above) present with this concern, Dealers are advised to contact the Technical Assistance Hotline .

Parts

Service Part Number	Claim Quantity	Package Order Quantity	Description
W707638-S900 or W707638-S900C	1 or 2	1	Rivet - Single acting rivet gun
W706770-S437	1 or 2	1	Rivet - Double acting rivet gun

Labor Times

Description	Operation No.	Time
Check and remove the B-Pillar trim panel and checking gap to compress the B-Pillar: AB flange as per the given service procedure (One side) (includes road test)	262221A	1.0 Hrs.
Check and remove the B-Pillar trim panel and checking gap to compress the B-Pillar: AB flange as per the given service procedure (Both sides) (includes road test)	262221B	1.8 Hrs.

Check and repair the B-Pillar trim panel ticking sound (One side) (Remove pillar and includes compress B-Pillar AB flange and install rivet as per the given service procedure includes road test)	262221C	1.2 Hrs.
Check and repair the B-Pillar trim panel ticking sound (Both sides) (Remove pillar and includes compress B-Pillar AB flange and install rivet as per the given service procedure includes road test)	262221D	2.2 Hrs.
Remove the B-pillar interior trim to expose the Body-In-White (BIW) sheet metal and the seat belt D-ring assembly (One side) (includes road test)	262221E	0.2 Hrs.
Remove the B-pillar interior trim to expose the Body-In-White (BIW) sheet metal and the seat belt D-ring assembly (Both sides) (includes road test)	262221F	0.3 Hrs.

Repair/Claim Coding

Causal Part:	2624382
Condition Code:	07

PDR Table

PDR Code	Description	Time
TSB262221A	Check and remove the B-Pillar trim panel and checking gap to compress the B-Pillar: AB flange as per the given service procedure (One side) (includes road test)	1.0 Hrs.
TSB262221B	Check and remove the B-Pillar trim panel and checking gap to compress the B-Pillar: AB flange as per the given service procedure (Both sides) (includes road test)	1.8 Hrs.
TSB262221C	Check and repair the B-Pillar trim panel ticking sound (One side) (Remove pillar and includes compress B-Pillar AB flange and install rivet as per the given service procedure includes road test) - Single Rivet Blind	1.2 Hrs.
TSB262221D	Check and repair the B-Pillar trim panel ticking sound (Both sides) (Remove pillar and includes compress B-Pillar AB flange and install rivet as per the given service procedure includes road test) - Single Rivet Blind	2.2 Hrs.
TSB262221E	Check and repair the B-Pillar trim panel ticking sound (One side) and Remove the B-pillar interior trim to expose the Body-In-White (BIW) sheet metal and the seat belt D-ring assembly (One side) (includes road test) - Single Rivet Blind	1.4 Hrs.
TSB262221F	Check and repair the B-Pillar trim panel ticking sound (Both sides) and Remove the B-pillar interior trim to expose the Body-In-White (BIW) sheet metal and the seat belt D-ring assembly (Both sides) (includes road test) - Single Rivet Blind	2.5 Hrs.
TSB262221G	Check and repair the B-Pillar trim panel ticking sound (One side) (Remove pillar and includes compress B-Pillar AB flange and install rivet as per the given service procedure includes road test) - Double Rivet Blind	1.2 Hrs.
TSB262221H	Check and repair the B-Pillar trim panel ticking sound (Both sides) (Remove pillar and includes compress B-Pillar AB flange and install rivet as per the given service procedure includes road test) - Double Rivet Blind	2.2 Hrs.
TSB262221I	Check and repair the B-Pillar trim panel ticking sound (One side) and Remove the B-pillar interior trim to expose the Body-In-White (BIW) sheet metal and the seat belt D-ring assembly (One side) (includes road test) - Double Rivet Blind	1.4 Hrs.
TSB262221J	Check and repair the B-Pillar trim panel ticking sound (Both sides) and Remove the B-pillar interior trim to expose the Body-In-White (BIW) sheet metal and the seat belt D-ring assembly (Both sides) (includes road test) - Double Rivet Blind	2.5 Hrs.

Tools and Materials Required

1. Protruding head structural steel rivet: Ford Standard part number is referred to as W707638-S900 or W707638-S900C or W706770-S437.

NOTE: Dealers can use rivet part number W707638-S900 and W707638-S900C for a single acting rivet gun and part number W706770-S437 for a double acting rivet gun.

2. Blind rivet tool

NOTE: The recommend rivet gun is a single acting rivet gun but dealers can use a double acting rivet gun too. (Refer to the rivet part number for the double acting rivet gun above).

Rivet Tool Technical Data

Battery-operated or pneumatic blind rivet tool that meets the following specifications:

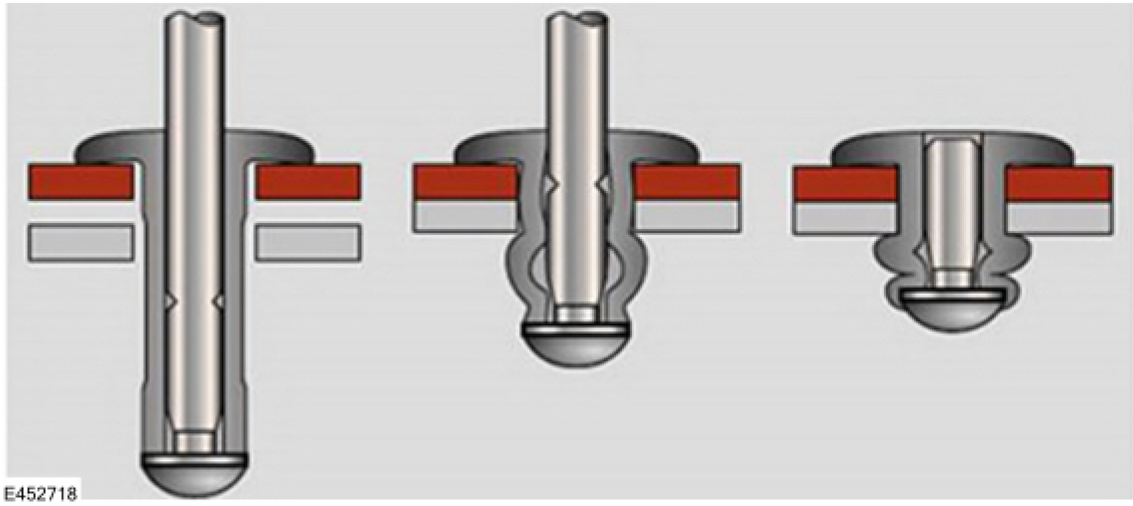
- Rivet size: 6.4mm (1/4")
- Minimum stroke: 17mm (0.67")
- Minimum pulling force: 16,000 N (3597 lb)
- Rivet mandrel length: 29mm (1.14")

NOTE: The correct rivet tool is required to ensure the rivets are installed properly to obtain effectiveness of the repair. Do not use a hand tool. If Dealers do not have a blind rivet tool meeting these requirements, they are recommended to outsource to a body shop to install the rivets using a blind rivet tool that does meet these requirements. Dealers can submit payment as a sublet cost in the warranty claim. (Figure 1)

CAUTION: Any rivets installed as a part of this TSB must meet the following installation requirements:

- Must sit on the panel completely with 360° surface contact to the panel.
- Must not be installed in inclined/angular position.
- Must not have any gap between the rivet and panel after installation.

Figure 1 - Rivet condition before and after correct installation.



3. Body color touch-up paint. (Zn-rich primer).

4. Suitable size drill bit (recommended 17/64" (6.75mm)).

5. Center drill.

6. Magnet.

7. Locking plier/C-clamp size 50mm.

8. Feeler gauge.

9. Interior trim remover.

10. Paper or soft material for paint protection while applying clamping.

11. Safety glasses.

12. Thick cloth or fabric (e.g., shop towel, microfiber cloth).

Diagnostic Procedure

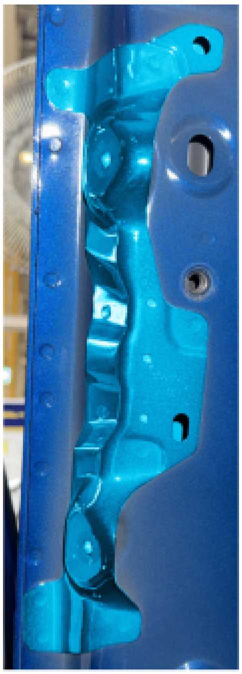
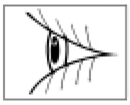
1. Remove the B-pillar trim panel. For additional information, refer to Workshop Manual (WSM) Section 501-05.

2. Check to ensure the vehicle is fitted with the new grab handle bracket design. (Figure 2)

(1). Yes - proceed to the relevant repair procedure below (refer to Scope below for further information).

(2). No - this TSB does not apply, refit the B-pillar trim panel and refer to the WSM for diagnosis/repair.

Figure 2

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Scope:

(1). 2023-2024 Ranger double cab and 2023-2024 Everest Thailand plant built from 23-Nov-2023 to 24-Apr-2024 and 2023-2024 Ranger double cab Vietnam plant built from 13-Jan-2024 to 25-May-2024:

- Follow Repair Procedure 1, 2 and 3 (where required) on one or both sides as required.

(2). 2023-2025 Ranger double cab and 2023-2025 Everest Thailand plant built from 25-Apr-2024 to 01-Aug-2024 and 2023-2024 Ranger double cab Vietnam plant built after 25-May-2024:

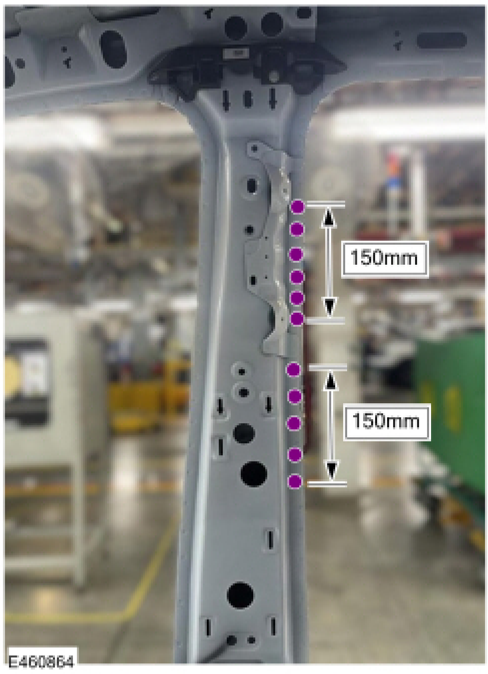
- Follow Repair Procedure 1 on one or both sides as required.

Procedure 1: C-Clamp Process on the AB Flange

Objective: To further eliminate any potential panel gaps and movement on the B-Pillar AB flange around the grab handle leg.

1. Initial Gap Check: Before clamping, use a feeler gauge to check for any existing gaps on the AB flange within the specific segments extending 150mm above and 150mm below the points where the grab handle bracket lower leg attaches to the B-pillar structure and note any observed gaps.
2. Identify Clamp Locations: Apply clamping force to the AB Flange within the specific segments extending 150mm above and 150mm below the points where the grab handle bracket lower leg attaches to the B-pillar structure. (Figure 3)

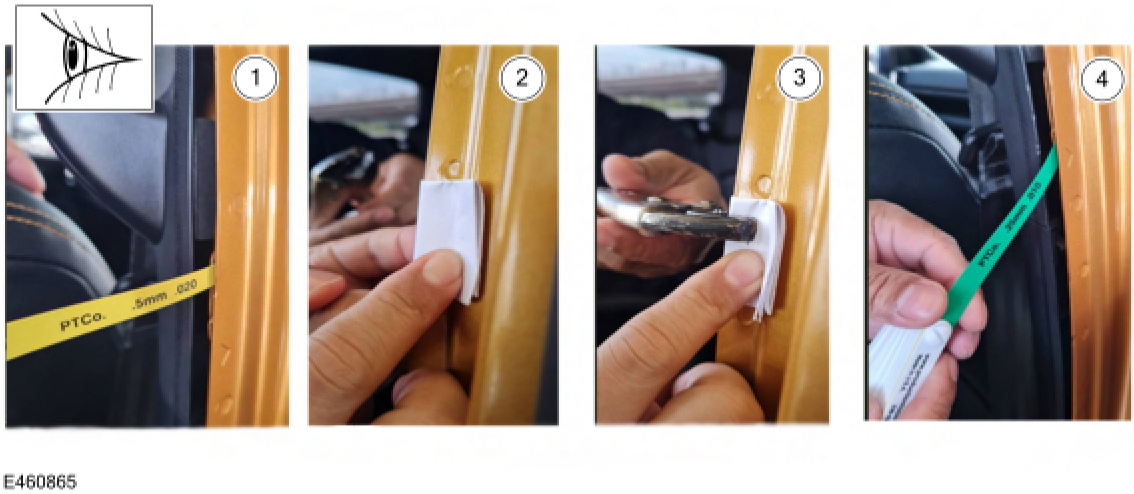
Figure 3 - AB Flange area for checking the gap and clamping



3. Apply C-Clamps: Place paper or a soft material between the clamp jaws and the panel surfaces to protect the paint finish.(Figure 4). Hand-tighten each C-clamp until a firm resistance is felt. DO NOT use tools to further tighten beyond hand-tightness, as this could damage the sheet metal or the clamp itself. The goal is to securely hold and compress the AB flange.

4. Verify Zero Gap: After applying the C-clamps, re-check the gaps at each clamped location using a feeler gauge. The post-process gap must be zero between the panels at all clamped points. If a gap remains, carefully re-adjust the clamp position or tightness within the hand-tightening limit.

Figure 4 - Check gap, apply clamp and confirm gap after clamping



Item	Description
1	Check gap before clamping
2	Place paper or a soft material
3	Apply clamp area line as mentioned in Step 2
4	Verify a zero gap

5. Recheck for the noise. After completing the clamping, perform a road test or simulate conditions that previously caused the ticking noise to confirm if the issue is resolved.

6. For 2023-2025 Ranger double cab and 2023-2025 Everest Thailand plant built from 25-Apr-2024 to 01-Aug-2024 and 2023-2024 Ranger double cab Vietnam plant built after 25-May-2024 - Refit the B-pillar trim panel. For additional information, refer to WSM Section 501-05.

7. For 2023-2024 Ranger double cab and 2023-2024 Everest Thailand plant built from 23-Nov-2023 to 24-Apr-2024 and 2023-2024 Ranger double cab Vietnam plant built from 13-Jan-2024 to 25-May-2024 vehicles – proceed to Repair Procedure 2.

Procedure 2: Adding Rivet

The following steps outline the procedure to add rivets to the B-pillar panel to eliminate the ticking noise. Due to manufacturing tolerances, spot weld locations can vary between vehicles. Rivets should be located within the zones highlighted, at a maximum distance from spot welds to achieve maximum effect. (Figure 5)

Figure 5

NOTE: Remove any swarf from the drilling process. Swarf will likely drop down into the lower area of the bodyside/rocker and/or into the carpet and create a red rust appearance and may cause a rattle noise if swarf is stuck between the grab handle bracket and B-pillar panel.

Install 1 rivet in the area shown above. (Figure 5)

NOTE: Spot weld locations may vary between vehicles and LH and RH side.

1. Take note of the spot weld(s) in the area.

2. Make a 6mm diameter mark at the center position. The recommended position of the center mark is 4mm from the side edge and 7mm from the lower edge. (Figure 6)

3. Use a center punch at the center of the mark.

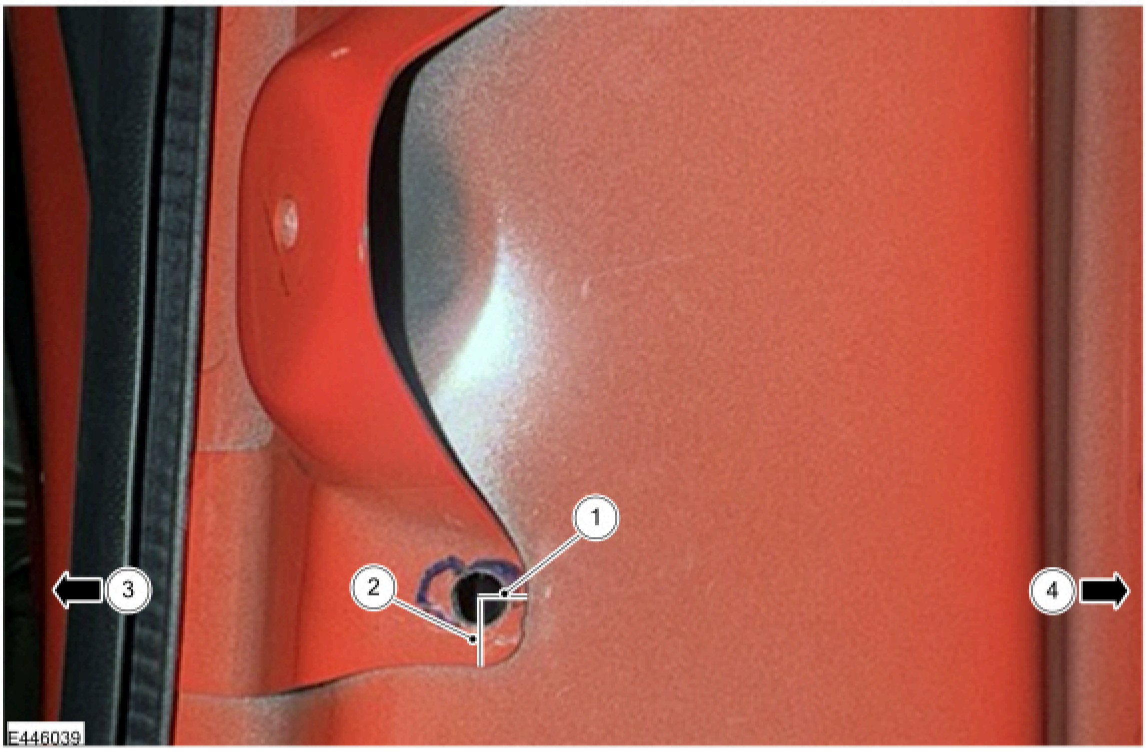
4. Drill with drill size 17/64” (6.75mm) the hole and apply touch up paint at the edge of the hole.

CAUTION: Do not drill the hole close to the radius of the bracket profile to avoid rivet dome head interference and incomplete riveting/rivet not fully seating.

5. Install the rivet.

LH side shown

Figure 6



Item	Description
1	4mm from the side edge
2	7mm from the lower edge
3	Rear
4	Front

6. Refit the B-pillar trim panel. For additional information, refer to WSM Section 501-05.

7. Recheck for the noise. Perform a road test or simulate conditions that previously caused the ticking noise to confirm if the issue is resolved. Has the issue been resolved?

(1). Yes - TSB complete.

(2). No – for 2023-2024 Ranger double cab and 2023-2024 Everest Thailand plant built from 23-Nov-2023 to 24-Apr-2024 and 2023-2024 Ranger double cab Vietnam plant built from 13-Jan-2024 to 25-May-2024 vehicles where the issue is still present – proceed to Repair Procedure 3 below.

Procedure 3: To isolate the source of a B-pillar "tick" noise and determine if it originates solely from the seat belt D-ring anchor plate assembly

CAUTION: DO NOT perform Procedure 3 unless:

• Procedure 1 (C-Clamp Process on the AB Flange) AND Procedure 2 (Adding Rivet) have been completed and failed to resolve the ticking noise, AND

• The triage process has conclusively determined that the ticking noise is unambiguously originating from the seat belt anchor plate area itself. This condition, where the noise is solely from the anchor plate after C-clamp efforts, is extremely rare. Technicians are strongly advised to resolve the issue using the C-clamp processes on the AB flange alone.

1. Remove the necessary B-pillar interior trim to expose the body-in-white (BIW) sheet metal and the seat belt D-ring assembly. For additional information, refer to WSM Section 501-05.

2. Ensure the seat belt D-ring fastening bolt is secured properly prior to testing.

3. Re-create the conditions known to produce the noise (e.g., static vibration simulation or a rough road test drive).

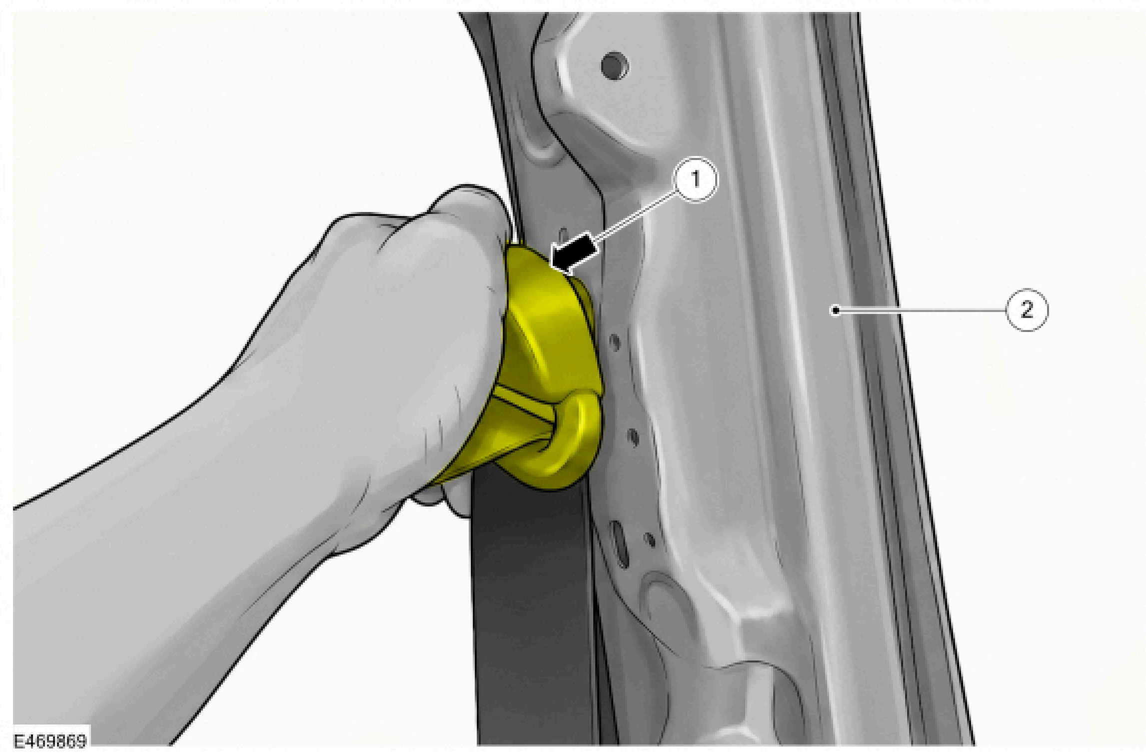
4. While the noise condition is present, apply firm manual pressure by tightly gripping the seat belt D-ring assembly, exactly as depicted in Figure 7 below.

Diagnostic Evaluation:

1. If the noise ceases completely while holding the D-ring: The source is isolated to the anchor plate assembly. Do not attempt repair. Contact the Technical Assistance Hotline for the detailed repair procedure.

2. If the noise persists while holding the D-ring: The source lies elsewhere in the B-pillar. Continue standard diagnosis to locate the root cause.

Figure 7



Item	Description
1	Hold the D-ring tightly to cut off the tick noise
2	B-pillar sheet metal Body In White (BIW)